

Illustration by SIDDHANT JUMDE

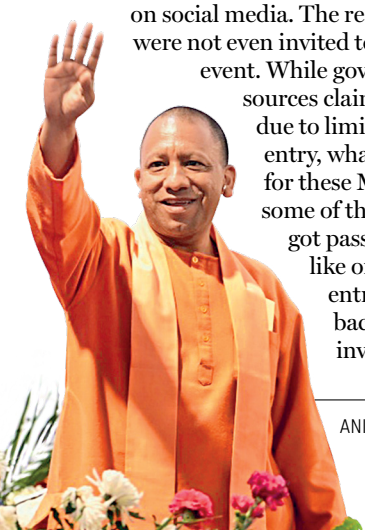
GLASSHOUSE

DOUBLE STANDARD

Remember the Udaipur resolution of the Congress in May last year? It talked of one member, one post. Nine months later, there is no sign of any honest effort by the party to keep its word. Mallikarjun Kharge, who was elected Congress president in October 2022, continues to be the leader of the party in the Rajya Sabha. Interestingly, when Rajasthan chief minister Ashok Gehlot, who was reportedly the Gandhi family's candidate for the presidential poll, expressed his desire to continue as CM, Rahul Gandhi publicly reminded him of the one person, one post rule. Things took a different turn eventually, but the Congress's first family does have different rules for different leaders.

LIMITED ENTRY

In the recently concluded Global Investors Summit in Uttar Pradesh, the **Yogi Adityanath** government says it signed MoUs worth over Rs 33.5 lakh crore. State ministers have hailed it as a big success. Most BJP MLAs, however, are not promoting it with the same zeal on social media. The reason? They were not even invited to this grand event. While government sources claim this was due to limited passes for entry, what was galling for these MLAs was that some of their supporters got passes. Seems like only those with entrepreneurial backgrounds were invited.



ANI

Potshot Politics





Janata Dal (Secular) leader **H.D. Kumaraswamy** recently took aim at Union minister **Pralhad Joshi** saying that there had been an RSS (Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh) move to make the latter the chief minister of Karnataka if the BJP won the upcoming state election. In doing so, he also brought up Joshi's "Peshwa Brahmin" roots. Kumaraswamy's angry comment came in response to Joshi's jibe at the "family politics" in the JD-S (Janata Dal-Secular), but political observers believe the shrewd ex-CM was also looking to stir things up, especially given the BJP's reliance on the Lingayat community in the state.



A New Icon

The Kolkata International Book Fair recently saw a new icon—Justice **Abhijit Ganguly**, who played a crucial role in unearthing the teachers' recruitment scam in West Bengal. There was a scramble for selfies and autographs with him as young men and women jostled with each other just to get a glimpse of their messiah. The ruling Trinamool Congress is naturally tense. Leaders are curious to know if he harbours any political ambitions. The judge, for now, has revealed his next course of action—writing a book. Will it reveal more than is known in the public domain about the recruitment scam?

DRESSING DOWN



Haryana's health minister **Anil Vij** has cracked the whip on healthcare professionals working in the state's facilities. They have been asked not to wear heavy jewellery, make-up or nail art. The men are required to have their hair, including on the face, trimmed. The most confounding is the ban on wearing jeans, skirts or T-shirts. Vij wants his doctors, nurses and other support staff to be dressed in uniform, the way their counterparts in private hospitals do. Dressing the part may be an honourable intent, but Vij could perhaps also focus on improving the health facilities in the state.

Kaushik Deka with Rohit Parihar, Anilesh S. Mahajan, Ajay Sukumaran, Prashant Srivastava and Romita Datta